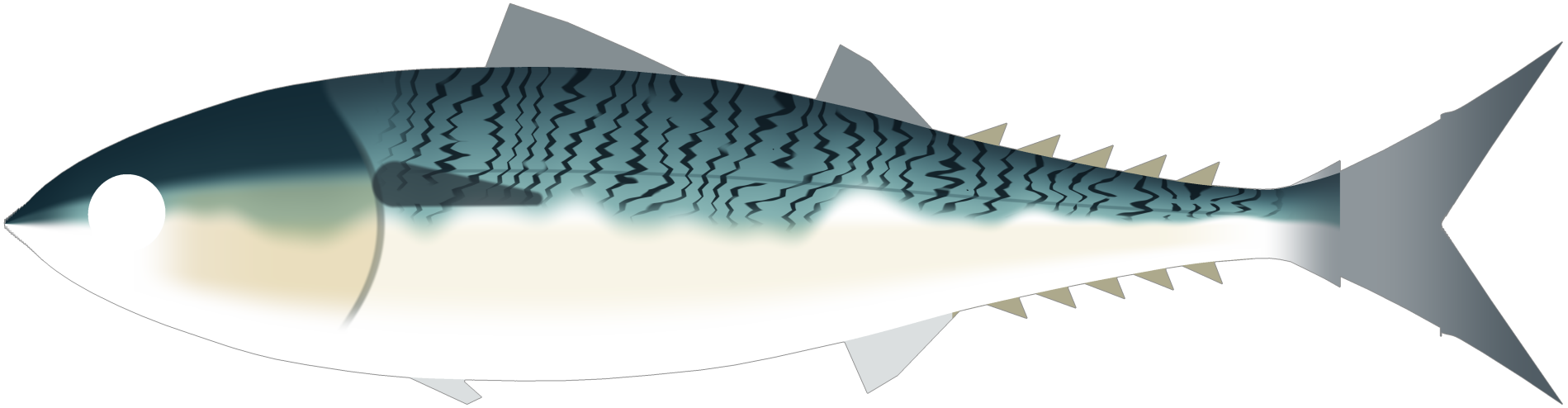
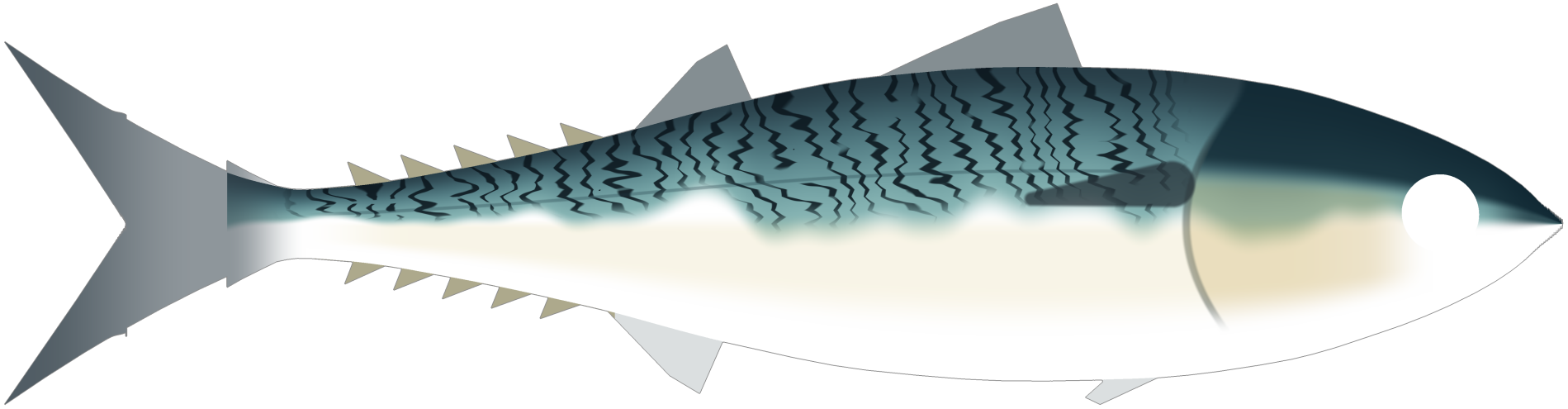
CHUB MACKEREL FLASHER — WATERSLIDE DECALS, 1:1

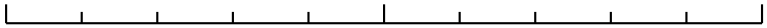
Print at 100% / 'Actual size' (no fit-to-page) on CLEAR inkjet or laser waterslide paper. White = unprinted = clear film, so the chrome base shows through.



LEFT flank (snout left) — trim on the grey line; eye hole is pre-cleared



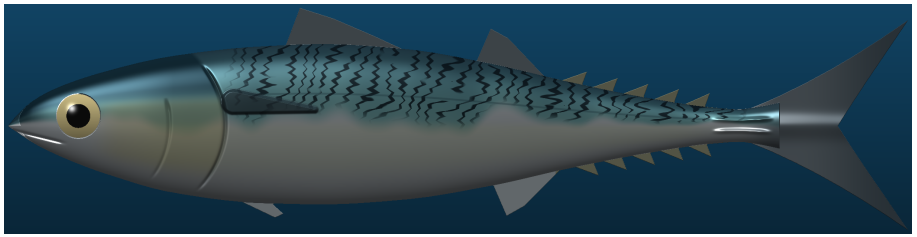
RIGHT flank (snout right)

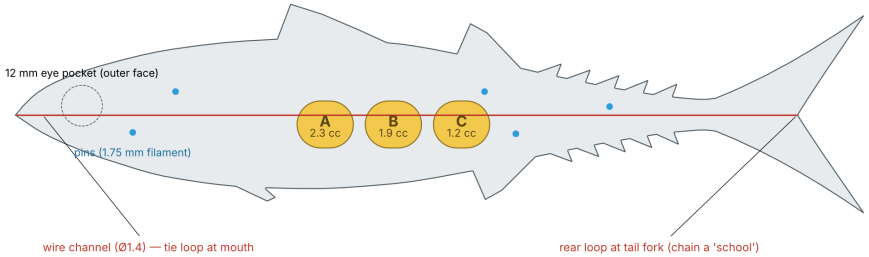


Scale check: this bar must measure exactly 100 mm. Decals are 'unrolled' to fit the curved flanks of the FL 230 mm model.

Pacific chub mackerel throw flasher — build sheet

Fork length 230 mm · total length 250 mm · 2 glued halves, each 10 mm tall · Scomber japonicus field marks (FAO/FishBase)





Ballast tuning (estimates, PETG at 100% infill, ~6 g epoxy topcoat)

Chambers filled	Dry wt	Net in sea	Sink rate*	to 10 m
All chambers epoxy only (no ballast)	105 g	22 g	0.22 m/s	46 s
B = tungsten putty (flat flutter - start here)	122 g	40 g	0.29 m/s	34 s
B = lead shot + epoxy	117 g	35 g	0.27 m/s	37 s
A + B = tungsten (nose-down glide/spiral)	143 g	60 g	0.36 m/s	28 s
A + B + C = tungsten (fast drop, current)	154 g	71 g	0.39 m/s	26 s

**Broadside flutter, Cd≈1.2. Real fall rate varies with how it flutters — test in a pool and tune.*

1 Print (each half flat-face down, no supports)

PETG or ASA (not PLA: brittle and creeps in sun/salt).
0.12 mm layers (or variable layer height on the flanks),
100% infill or 6+ walls so water can't soak in and change weight.
Print one LEFT and one RIGHT half.

2 Rig

Stainless wire Ø1.0 mm (or 80-100 lb mono) through the channel,
loop at the mouth (line tie) and a loop at the tail fork.
Fill chambers per the table (tungsten putty or lead shot),
set 5 filament pins, flood chambers + faces with 30-min epoxy,
clamp. Sand the seam and layer lines (240 -> 400 wet).

3 Make it reflect

Base the whole fish in mirror chrome: chrome foil tape / foil
leaf, or a mirror-chrome spray over gloss black.
Optional: holographic film on the lower flank only.

4 Pattern

Seal the printed decal sheet with 2-3 light clear coats; dry.
Trim, soak, slide on; use decal-setting solution so it hugs
the curve. Seam = dorsal/belly midline. Colour inks over chrome
read as metallic 'candy' blue-green; the clear belly stays bright.
Stick a 12 mm 3D eye (silver/gold iris, black pupil) in each pocket.

5 Seal

Two coats of clear 2-part lure epoxy (rotate while it cures).

Field use

Toss it a few metres away and let it flutter down on a light line;
B-only flutters and flashes like a dying bait. Chain 2-3 by the
tail loops for a mini 'school'. Check local rules on attractors.